

7.4.1 Performing

Assessment Criteria for Performing a Solo Part or Piece

When making their assessment, teachers are reminded that the standard of performing expected is one that can be met by candidates who have received tuition only in the classroom situation.

The assessment criteria for performing have been designed to give greater weighting to the musicality of the performance than to the difficulty of the part being assessed. Candidates should be advised to select pieces that enable them to demonstrate their musicality. It is important to appreciate that it is better to perform a simple piece well than a more difficult piece badly.

The part to be assessed must be allocated a mark out of 10 using the following indicators:

1 - 2 marks	The performance has a little fluency but does not communicate the intended effect of the piece.
3 - 4 marks	The performance has some fluency and uses tempo, dynamics and phrasing appropriately. It attempts to communicate the intention of the piece.
5 - 6 marks	The performance is fluent and demonstrates technical control adequate to the demand of the music. It communicates the intention of the piece with some success.
7 - 8 marks	The performance is confident and fluent and displays good technical control appropriate to the demand of the piece. It has a sense of direction and shape and communicates the intended effect successfully.
9 – 10 marks	The performance demonstrates confidence and fluency with technical control which supports musical expression. The performer provides a convincing and memorable interpretation of the piece.

This initial mark for the performance of the assessed part (maximum 10) is to be added to a mark out of 5 based on the technical difficulty of the part performed:

0 - 1 marks	A simple piece which uses a limited rhythmic and /or melodic range with easy movement between notes, in an easy key
2 – 3 marks	A piece which requires a range of rhythmic and/or melodic change with some technical demands in terms of articulation, phrasing, gradations of dynamics and key.
4 – 5 marks	A more complex piece involving sustained control, with more intricate technical demands in terms of an extended range and control of tempo, dynamics and phrasing.

Once a mark out of 15 is obtained it should be multiplied by 3 to give a mark out of 45.

The difficulty mark is to be determined by using the descriptors in this specification and not by using the criteria of other examining bodies. Exemplar guidance on the assessment of the level of difficulty on different instruments/voice is given in Appendix B. It is not appropriate for candidates to attempt to play a piece of music which is significantly beyond them in technical difficulty. Marks will be awarded for what is achieved by the candidate, not merely for what is attempted. The difficulty mark should reflect this. In order to ensure that this is clear, difficulty marks will not exceed musicality marks.

Assessment Criteria for Performing an Individual Part in an Ensemble

When making their assessment, teachers are reminded that the standard expected is one that can be met by candidates who have received tuition only in the classroom situation.

The assessment criteria for performing have been designed to give greater weighting to the musicality of the performance than to the difficulty of the part being assessed. Candidates should be advised to select pieces that enable them to demonstrate their musicality. It is important to appreciate that it is better to perform a simple piece well than a more difficult piece badly.

The part assessed is to be allocated a mark out of 10 using the following indicators:

1 - 2 marks	The performance has a little fluency but does not communicate the intended effect of the piece. The ensemble is held together mainly by the other performer(s).
3 - 4 marks	The performance has some fluency and uses tempo, dynamics and phrasing appropriately. It attempts to communicate the intention of the piece. The candidate demonstrates awareness of the other performer(s).
5 - 6 marks	The performance is fluent and demonstrates technical control adequate to the demand of the music. It communicates the intention of the piece with some success. The candidate co-ordinates their part with the other performer(s).
7 -8 marks	The performance is confident and fluent and displays good technical control appropriate to the demand of the piece. It has a sense of direction and shape and communicates the intended effect successfully. The candidate performs with sensitivity to the other part(s), making appropriate adjustments to meet the demands of co-ordination and balance.
9 – 10 marks	The performance demonstrates confidence and fluency with technical control which supports musical expression. The performer provides a convincing and memorable interpretation of the piece. The candidate demonstrates empathy with the other performer(s).

This initial mark for the performance of the assessed part (maximum 10) is to be added to a mark out of 5 based on the technical difficulty of the part performed:

0 - 1 marks	A simple piece which uses a limited rhythmic and /or melodic range with easy movement between notes, in an easy key.
2 – 3 marks	A piece which requires a range of rhythmic and/or melodic change with some technical demands in terms of articulation, phrasing, gradations of dynamics and key.
4 – 5 marks	A more complex piece involving sustained control, with more intricate technical demands in terms of an extended range and control of tempo, dynamics and phrasing.

Once a mark out of 15 is obtained it should be multiplied by 3 to give a mark out of 45.

The difficulty mark is to be determined by using the descriptors in this specification and not by using the criteria of other examining bodies. Exemplar guidance on the assessment of the level of difficulty on different instruments/voice is given in Appendix B. It is not appropriate for candidates to attempt to play a piece of music which is significantly beyond them in technical difficulty. Marks will be awarded for what is achieved by the candidate, not merely for what is attempted. The difficulty mark should reflect this. In order to ensure that this is clear, difficulty marks will not exceed musicality marks.

Credit for the musical use of ICT when performing a solo part or piece

Where a candidate uses technology to enhance musically a live performance of a solo part or piece, credit may be given for the enhancement through the marks awarded for musicality. Enhancement does not affect the difficulty mark. Musical enhancement may apply in one of three ways:

- effects added during or after the recording of the performance of the piece;
- the use of multi-tracking;
- the use of a computer/midi/sequencing package.

The assessment is carried out as follows:

- the 'live' part is first assessed using the criteria for technical difficulty. In multi-tracked performances this part must be clearly identified by the Centre on the assessment form;
- the quality of the whole performance (with added effect, other parts etc) is then assessed using the criteria for musicality;
- the two marks are added together.

Centres must observe the following points when assessing performing which involves the use of technology:

- the part to be assessed must initially be performed live;
- full details of the technology used must be provided using the **Use of Technology Form**;
- the enhancement process must be clearly documented and authenticated by the teacher;
- the candidate must be responsible for the enhancement;
- the only basis for awarding credit is the solo performing criteria in section 7.3.1;
- where the outcome differs significantly from the live input, or where the live input is difficult to identify aurally, a recording of both will be required for assessment.